

Contemplative Walk

Aknowlegement - Bede Haughey

Prayers and Reflections to use at beginning or end of contemplative walk:

CONTEMPLATION is a way of slowing down…

So as to descend into the depths of yourself in the present moment where God

[Unitive Love] lies waiting to grant you a deep experience of your eternal

oneness with all creation and Creator.

James Finley

CHRISTIAN SPIRITUALITY proposes an alternative understanding of the quality of

life, and encourages a prophetic and contemplative lifestyle, one capable of

deep enjoyment free of the obsession with consumption…To be serenely

present to each reality, however small it may be, opens us to much greater

horizons of understanding and personal fulfilment…It is a return to that

simplicity which allows us to stop and appreciate the small things, to be

grateful for the opportunities which life affords us…

Laudato Si’ 222

PSALM 139 : 7 - 10

Where can I go from your spirit? Or where can I flee from your presence?

If I ascend to heaven, you are there; if I make my bed in Sheol, you are there.

If I take the wings of the morning and settle at the farthest limits of the sea,

even there your hand shall lead me, and your right hand shall hold me fast.

O Creator God, open our hearts and our eyes to the wonder of your presence among us.

May we see the signs of your beauty Within us and about us

And ever be in awe of the simple gifts of life.

Help us reach beyond ourselves

And to give thanks for all your creation that shares this universe with us:

Peoples of every nation, Animals of every species,

All forms of vegetation, The planets, stars, and all the elements.

We pray this in union with the Incarnate Word In whose image all was created.



Amen

INSPIRE IN US A SPIRIT OF AWE

Divine Creator, God,

We thank You for the wonder
of the universe

and its eons of time and life
that has sustained us.

We thank You for our sister mother
earth, her beauty and
the bounty of her days

and her sacred ground



SADLY, we have abused earth's sacred
space and have misread its sacred story,
claiming it as our own,
opposing Your divine plan.
Its gift of sustainability has been snatched
away, diminishing its sustenance
for the good of all.

Yes, we can hear its anguished cries of
pain and its resources stripped bare,
its climate distorted its water and soil
poisoned, its landscape unable to cope.



Creator God,

Help us to care for sister mother earth

with loving attention to its sacred journey.

As it gives of itself without measure.

Inspire in us a spirit of awe for its beauty and many life forms.

And may we be thankful knowing that it waits unceasingly

to refurbish itself for our sake.

Amen.

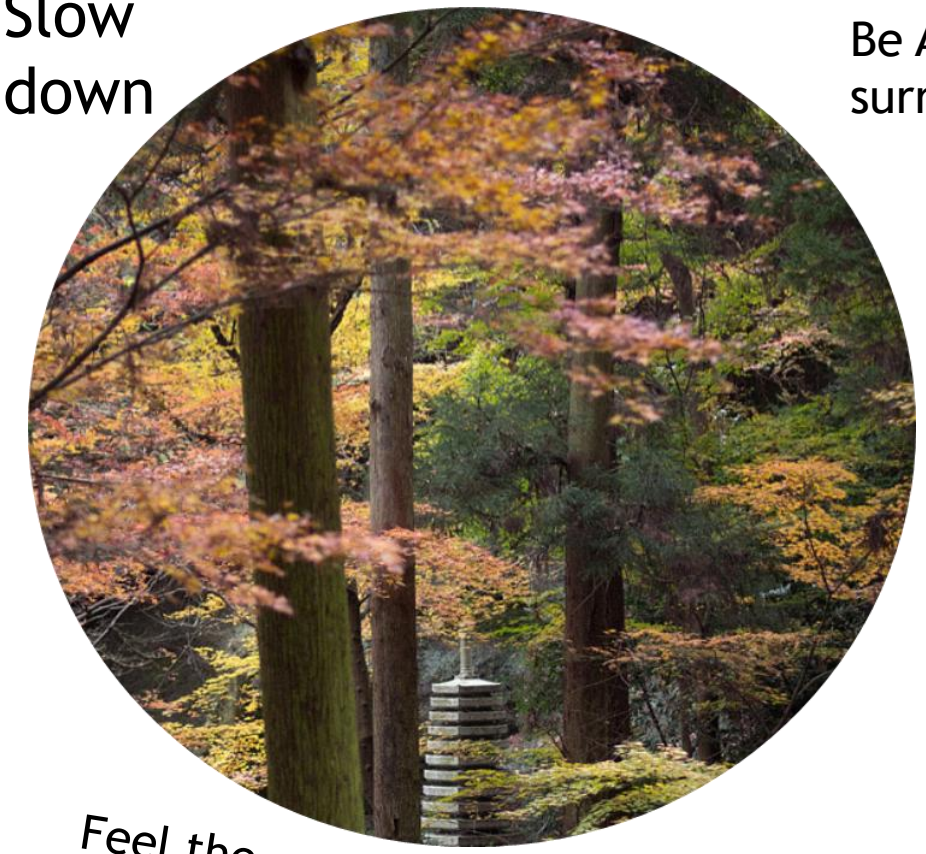
Sr. Maura Fitzsimons, PBVM, Laudato Si' Animator, Mississippi USA.

CONTEMPLATIVE WALK



Maybe sing a hymn in you head

Slow down



Be Aware of your surroundings

Look up

Look down

Allow yourself to be at one with nature.

Be ‘present’

Be still

Be quiet

Live in the “Mystery”

Surrender to the moment

Feel the peace

‘Be’ rather than ‘do’

See nature at work

Feel the earth beneath you

Focus on the moment rather than walk around too much – you might miss something!

Be content with your own company

Are there any outside noises that disturb you? concentrate on your inner feelings and senses



REVIEW: CONTEMPLATIVE WALK



(We are all in the same location
but we share diverse experiences)

What was it like for me today?

What did I notice? Within me, around me?

Is there something new here for me?



Where did I encounter God / His Presence/ Mystery?



What action do I sense God calling me to?

Try this technique at home or anywhere at any time - you need to distress

- Build a picture or image in your mind of somewhere you have been that you loved
- Where do you go to find peace – physically or in your mind?
- Shut yourself off - just for a few minutes to re-energize
- Try yoga or meditation – music poetry – go for a contemplative walk

Rearranged by Sylvia Mellish for CWLANZ

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